lions of riders booking trips provided by thousands of drivers in cities all around the world.

Although a global ridesharing application would likely have a very large codebase covering dozens or hundreds of models and database tables, Rideshare has less than ten models and tables. The portion of the domain model is a small core or sample that's needed mainly for demonstration purposes in examples and exercises you'll see.

The core nouns you'll work with are *Drivers*, *Riders*, *Trips*, and *Trip Requests*. These are Active Record models that are backed by database tables.

As a refresher or if you're newer to Rails, Active Record is the Object Relational Mapper (ORM) framework for Ruby on Rails. Active Record connects object oriented Ruby classes as application code, to the persistence layer. Active Record Objects are instantiated in memory and when they're saved or updated, a corresponding INSERT or UPDATE is sent to PostgreSQL.

Active Record works with many naming conventions that are important to know. Models use a singular form for names like "Driver" in memory but by convention are persisted into a table with a pluralized name like drivers. The *Convention Over Configuration* design principle that's a code aspect of Ruby on Rails means that things like a table name in a model does not need to be configured explicitly.

Rideshare has an *Entity Relationship Diagram* (ERD) available as a PDF in the root directory of the project. The ERD is automatically updated when schema changes are made. See the footnote with a link to the ERD where you can visualize the database tables and their relationships.[1]

Active Record Schema Management Refresher

Active Record tracks database schema changes in a file. The file may be in a Ruby format or a SQL format. Rideshare uses the SQL format. After every schema modification is made, the Rideshare database schema is dumped into the file db/structure.sql, which is version controlled. This file will always have the latest version of the schema.

When you're working with a new Rails application, explore the db/structure.sql file and any available diagrams like ERDs, to begin to learn about the tables, indexes, and constraints.

1. https://github.com/andyatkinson/rideshare/blob/master/erd.pdf